

02 — CONVERSATION STATES

MASTER_CORE v2.4 Knowledge Base. Research-informed reference material; not a universal rulebook. SYNTHETIC examples are illustrative. Future private REAL_CASE data must be labeled separately and must not be fabricated.

State taxonomy

- OPENING — new topic or episode.
- BUILDING — reciprocal engagement is forming.
- FLOWING — sustained natural exchange.
- DEEPENING — more personal meaning or disclosure.
- PLAYFUL — humor, teasing or banter is sustained.
- LOW_ENERGY — short/limited responses; cause unknown.
- PAUSE — natural resting point.
- REOPENING — a quiet thread becomes active again.
- TOPIC_TRANSITION — current topic closes and another emerges.
- REPAIR — misunderstanding or mismatch needs correction.
- ENDPOINT — natural conversational closure.
- DEAD_CHAT — repeated attempts fail to create reciprocal material.

State detection

- Use recent turns, response expansion, reciprocal questions, voluntary sharing, closure cues and timing.
- STATE != INTEREST. LOW_ENERGY is not automatically LOW_INTEREST.
- STAGE != STATE. The same stage can contain multiple states.

Transitions

- OPENING → BUILDING when reciprocal engagement appears.
- BUILDING → FLOWING when both sides expand.
- FLOWING → DEEPENING when personal content becomes mutual and appropriate.
- FLOWING → PLAYFUL when playful framing is reciprocated.
- FLOWING → ENDPOINT when closure is natural.
- ENDPOINT + meaningful new message → REOPENING.

Retrieval tags

- STATE / OPENING / FLOWING / PLAYFUL / LOW_ENERGY / PAUSE / REOPENING / ENDPOINT / REPAIR

WEB / RESEARCH SOURCE NOTES

Research on self-disclosure / appropriateness: Supports treating disclosure depth, narrativity, frequency and perceived appropriateness as contextual variables rather than fixed rules.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5348110/>

Research on online disclosure: Shows online disclosure effects differ by context and that nonresponse online can have multiple causes; supports avoiding simplistic interpretations.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6398828/>

Partner responsiveness and closeness: Supports the relevance of emotional disclosure and perceived responsiveness to closeness/relationship adjustment.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC7381078/>

Hybrid RAG architecture: Example of BM25 + dense retrieval + reranking + LLM evaluation; used here only as architecture inspiration, not as dating advice.

<https://github.com/tim-ponomarev/hybrid-rag>

Hybrid RAG project: Example of document-type-aware hybrid retrieval using dense and sparse search.

<https://github.com/gwyer/hybrid-rag-project>